

RIGHT, WRONG, STILL OPEN

What Baring-Gould claimed and what became of it. The short version: the philology held, the mythology did not, and the medicine was replaced by something much narrower.

What he claimed	Verdict	Why
The Norse werewolf is the berserk	SUSTAINED	Still the standard reading. His handling of hamr and hamrammr is what a philologist would say now.
Vargr means both wolf and outlaw	SUSTAINED	The best single observation in the book, and underrated: a legal fiction of wolfishness helping to produce a literal belief.
English folklore is thin because the wolf went extinct	SUSTAINED	Correct, and his etymology is too: wer is Old English for man.
The trials record something real	AS HISTORY, NOT AS EVIDENCE	The records are genuine. The confessions inside them were obtained under torture or its threat and are evidence about a procedure first.
Two courts saw an illness where their century saw a wolf	SUSTAINED	Paris 1598 and Bordeaux 1603. He prints both judgments and passes over what they mean.
Lycanthropy is caused by an innate cruelty	NOT SUSTAINED	A moral category, not a diagnosis. Replaced by clinical lycanthropy — rare, delusional, and almost always secondary to another illness.
The ointments produced the sensation	PLAUSIBLE, THINLY EVIDENCED	The pharmacology of the nightshades is real; the historical evidence that such salves were in use is a handful of early modern recipes, several recorded by prosecutors.
The werewolf is a nature-myth	NOT SUSTAINED	Comparative mythology at its high tide. Demolished within his lifetime, largely by Andrew Lang, for explaining anything and therefore nothing.
The Hungarian countess bathed in blood	NOT SUSTAINED	Elizabeth Báthory. The blood-bathing is not in the record of her case and appears more than a century after her death.
The human hyæna confirms the thesis	BACKWARDS	It shows the pathology with no folklore attached — because by 1849 the explanation on offer was medical. The wolf was the vocabulary, not the disease.

From The Book of Were-Wolves by Sabine Baring-Gould, Valice Classics 15. Free at valicepress.com companion book-of-were-wolves